

Cheese Cake No1

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Yield: 16 servings

FOR THE CRUST

1¾ cups graham cracker crumbs

3 tablespoons sugar

Pinch of salt

½ stick (4 tablespoons) unsalted butter, melted

FOR THE CHEESECAKE

2 pounds (four 8-ounce boxes) cream cheese, at room temperature

1⅓ cups sugar

½ teaspoon salt

2 teaspoons pure vanilla extract

4 large eggs, at room temperature

1⅓ cups sour cream or heavy cream, or a combination of the two

Step 3

Center a rack in the oven. Heat the oven to 350 degrees and place the springform on a baking sheet. Bake for 10 minutes. Set the crust aside to cool on a rack while you make the cheesecake.

Step 4

Reduce the oven temperature to 325 degrees.

Step 5

to boil.

To make the cheesecake: Put a kettle of water on

Step 6

Working with a stand mixer, preferably fitted with the paddle attachment, or with a hand mixer in a large bowl, beat the cream cheese at medium speed until it is soft and creamy, about 4 minutes.

With the mixer running, add the sugar and salt and continue to beat for another 4 minutes or so, until the cream cheese is light. Beat in the vanilla.

Add the eggs, one by one, beating for 1 full minute after each addition — you want a well-aerated batter. Reduce the mixer speed to low and stir in the sour cream and/or

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heavy cream.

Bake the cheesecake for 1 hour 30 minutes, at which point the top will be browned (and perhaps cracked) and may have risen just a little above the rim of the pan. Turn off the oven's heat and prop the oven door open with a wooden spoon.

Allow the cheesecake to luxuriate in its water bath for another hour.

Step 10

After 1 hour, carefully pull the setup out of the oven, lift the springform pan out of the roaster — be careful, there may be some hot water in the aluminum foil — and remove the foil. Let the cheesecake come to room temperature on a cooling rack.

Step 11

When the cake is cool, cover the top lightly and refrigerate for at least 4 hours, although overnight is better.

Step 12

At serving time, remove the sides of the springform pan — you can use a hairdryer to do this — and set the cake on a serving platter.